DIGITAL LITERACY PORTFOLIO

PROJECT REPORT

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

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Introduction

This project has been completed as part of my role as a Student Digital Ambassador whose purpose is to assist fellow students in using various digital tools intelligently, safely and in a professional manner. The portfolio presents a combination of visual communications, online profiles, collaboration tools, professional email writing, and cybercrime awareness - as a single practical submission. Each task was created to demonstrate a true digital skill that students require while attending college and after graduation. Through this assignment, I have gained an understanding that digital literacy consists of much more than just the ability to use devices and apps; it encompasses judgement about safety, communication, and identity within the digital world. The contents of this repository demonstrate both technical knowledge and appropriate behaviour when using digital resources; both are crucial for continuing academic achievement and future career advancement.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For the first task, I created a one-page infographic to explain the meaning and importance of digital literacy in a simple and visually structured format. The design covers key areas such as the definition of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. I used a presentation-style visual layout so that the content remains easy to read at a glance and useful for awareness sharing among batchmates. The infographic was designed to look clean, modern, and informative instead of overly decorative, because the main purpose was clarity. Canva was the primary tool used to design the infographic with a clean layout, proper color contrast, and easy-to-understand visual elements. One thing I thought was really cool when completing this task is how much can be conveyed through design when the information is brief and organised clearly. The challenge was finding the right balance between the level of graphics being used and the amount of information provided, because if there are too many graphics it will take the attention off of the message. I learned that digital awareness materials are much more effective visually and in their succinctness, and I learned that digital literacy encompasses skills, responsibility, communication and safety, as opposed to simply being knowledge based

Task 2 – Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

The three sites I have chosen to use to create a base student digital portfolio are GitHub, LinkedIn, and kaggle. GitHub is a repository of projects, documenting progress on them, and tracking technical ability over time. Using LinkedIn allows me to develop a professional image and network as I build relationships with recruiters, professors, alumni, and people in the industry. kaggle provides datasets, coding notebooks,and competitions where users can solve real-worldproblems using data.. Over the next four years, I will use GitHub for documenting the projects I complete academically and personally; I will use LinkedIn for documenting my accomplishments and growth professionally;. This assignment helped me realize that a digital profile is a continual portfolio that will develop with me as I complete projects, gain experience, earn certifications, and develop skills. If I keep these sites professional from the very beginning, I will create solid avenues for internship, collaboration, and future education opportunities. All newly created or updated profiles need to be documented by taking screenshots and placing them in my repository as evidence of completion.

Task 3 – Explore Coding and Collaboration Platforms

In this task, I worked with two categories of tools: a coding practice platform and Google Workspace collaboration tools. I used two main types of tools to achieve my goals: coding practice platforms like HackerRank, and Google Workspace for collaboration. HackerRank is an excellent way for beginners to practice coding skills. The site has beginner-friendly practice problems that teach each student how to build logic and also learn how a platform works when completing a code challenge or project. Even completing a simple coding challenge gives participants confidence, and shows that an online environment (ex: HackerRank) has a specific structure. I created a Google Forms Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for collaborative purposes. The purpose of this quiz is to assess how much students know about digital safety, professional behaviour online, creating secure passwords, and communicating in a responsible manner. HackerRank helps students learn how to solve problems and build discipline around code creation, while Google Forms and Sheets help students develop teamwork skills, collect data, and manage information through their collaborative efforts. Overall, I am happy that this project gave me a hands-on experience that was relevant to the work that I do today. This experience can be translated directly to help students in their respective academic clubs, completing classroom surveys, preparing to take coding examinations, and organizing events. Before turning in this project, I will take screenshots of the HackerRank code challenge, and

create links to the Google Forms response sheet, then submit them as part of the project in the repository README.

Task 4 – Draft a Professional Email and Etiquette Guide

A common problem in digital communication occurs when students send casual or unclear emails to faculty members or professional contacts. For example, a student may write a message without a subject line, proper greeting, or full explanation, which can make the email look careless and reduce the chance of receiving a helpful response. In a professional setting, poor communication can create confusion, delay, or a negative impression. To avoid this, emails should include a clear subject line, a respectful greeting, a brief but complete body, and a proper sign-off with identity details. Through this task, I learned that professional communication is not about writing long emails; it is about writing clear, respectful, and purposeful ones. The social media checklist in this task also reinforces the idea that responsible digital behaviour matters not only in formal emails but also on public platforms where a student's digital footprint can affect reputation and opportunities.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study and Prevention Guide

For this task, I selected UPI/fraud cases as the cybercrime topic because it is one of the most common and relevant online threats for students. While researching cybercrime, what surprised me the most was how simple tricks, like fake screenshots or urgent messages, can lead to serious financial loss. Many scams rely on psychological manipulation, targeting trust and lack of awareness. I realized that educated individuals, including college students, can fall victim to such scams if they are not cautious. One personal habit I would change after researching this topic is that I will slow down before responding to any urgent-looking digital message, especially one related to payments, login alerts, or account verification. I will check the sender, verify the website address, and never share OTPs or UPI PINs. This task made me understand that cyber safety begins with everyday habits. A student who knows how to identify fraud early can prevent financial loss, identity misuse, and long-term account compromise.

Conclusion

The project caused me to transform my understanding of digital literacy from a limited technical skill set (i.e. computer skills) to a very real overall life skill that includes areas such as visual communication, professional identity, collaboration, proper use of email and cybersecurity. Furthermore, the project demonstrated that students can establish positive digital habits as they enter the world of higher education by using simple technology/tools like GitHub, LinkedIn, Google forms, etc. and following rules of appropriate communication. Ultimately, this portfolio exemplifies (only) an awareness of digital literacy and a practical application thereof since this is the primary objective of Digital Literacy.